

SOFTWARE RELEASE PLAN

Novus: *Smart Editorial & Publishing Platform*

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1 Introduction

1.1 Purpose of the release plan

This Release Plan defines the scope, features, dependencies, testing activities, deployment procedures, risks, rollback procedures, and post-release activities required for the first iteration of the Novus Smart Editorial & Publishing Platform.

The release aims to provide BOSS Magazine PH with a centralized Content Management System that manages the article lifecycle from drafting and AI-assisted pre-screening through editorial review, finalization, publishing, and reader access.

The system also introduces subscription-based premium content, payment processing, reader services, and administrative platform monitoring.

1.2 Goals and objectives of the release:

The production release aims to:

1. Centralize all article submissions and workflow states.
2. Provide a visual editorial pipeline for tracking articles.
3. Replace fragmented communication-based coordination with a structured workflow.
4. Provide centralized version control for article revisions.
5. Automate initial article screening using Gemini AI.
6. Evaluate grammar, brand alignment, and readability.
7. Enable reader registration and subscriptions.
8. Provide premium content access.
9. Provide analytics and revenue monitoring.
10. Provide an administrative Platform Control Plane.

1.3 Scope of the release (what's included and excluded):

1.3.1 Included:

Editorial Management - Article submission, Article version control, Audit logging.

AI-Assisted Review - AI assessment results, AI pre-screening, Grammar evaluation.

Graphics Management - Image upload, Asset version control etc.

Publishing - Issue release date, Approved article publishing, and public portal publishing.

1.3.2 Excluded:

- Native mobile applications.
- Offline functionality.

2 Release Information

- Release name & version: Novus v1.0
- Target release date: TBD
- Release type: Major

3 Team and Roles

3.1 Key stakeholders:

- BOSS Media Philippines
- Publisher
- Editors
- Writers
- Graphics Designers
- Readers
- Subscribers
- Project Adviser

3.1.1 Human Resources

Development team:

- Project Manager / Team Lead
- Developer Team

Testing team:

- QA/Lead
- Selected Publisher/Editor users
- Selected Writer/Designer users
- Selected Reader/Subscriber users

Release Management:

- Project Manager / Release Manager
- Development Lead
- QA Lead

- Client Representative

Other relevant roles:

- Client/Publisher Representative
- System Administrator
- Technical Support

4 Scope and Features

4.1 List of features to be included in the release:

- Article Pipeline - Create article, submit article, Track article status, Approve/reject article, Maintain audit history.
- AI Assessment - Submit article for AI evaluation, Grammar evaluation, Brand alignment evaluation, Readability evaluation, generate assessment results, Allow editor override.
- Graphics - Allow editor override, View asset history, Maintain V2/V3 asset versions, Upload PDF bundles.
- Publishing - Publish approved articles, Set Issue Release Date, prevent publishing of unapproved content, Confirm published article count.

4.2 User stories or requirements:

- As a Writer, I can create and submit articles through Novus so that my work can be tracked through the editorial pipeline.
- As an Editor, I can review articles, revisions, AI assessment results, and the Editor's Brief so that I can make informed editorial decisions.
- As a Graphics Designer, I can access assigned articles and submit associated graphics or layout assets.
- As a Publisher, I can review finalized content and publish approved articles.
- As a Reader, I can register and subscribe to access premium content and browse and search articles through a responsive bilingual website.
- As a Subscriber, I can access premium articles across my authenticated devices.
- As a Subscriber, I can save articles to my personal library and manage or cancel my subscription.
- As a System Administrator, I can manage platform-wide configuration, monitor APIs, and review audit logs.

4.3 Dependencies:

< external dependencies >

- Gemini AI service
- Web hosting/infrastructure
- Database services
- Internet connectivity
- Production domain and SSL configuration
- Authentication services

4.4 Out-of-scope items:

<specifically list items/features that wont be covered>.

- Native mobile app
- Offline system

5 Release Schedule

5.1 Timeline of activities:

Start Date	End Date	Activity	Notes
TBD	TBD	Development Phase: Development of core Novus features, including authentication, role-based workspaces, article creation, editorial workflow, and public website.	
TBD	TBD	System Integration: Integration of editorial workflow, AI services, public website, subscription system, payment system, and administration modules.	
TBD	TBD	System Testing: Full testing of the integrated Novus platform, including functional, integration, security, performance, and usability testing.	
TBD	TBD	User Acceptance Testing: UAT with selected client representatives, editorial users, and representative reader/subscriber users.	
TBD	TBD	Final Fixes & Performance Tuning: Resolution of critical defects, performance optimization, security validation, and release preparation.	
TBD	TBD	Soft Deployment: Limited production deployment for selected users.	
TBD	TBD	Monitoring & Feedback: Monitor system performance and collect feedback from pilot users.	
TBD	TBD	Official Release: Production release of Novus following successful UAT and release sign-off.	

5.2 Key milestones:

- Development completion: TBD
- Testing phases: TBD
 - Unit Testing Completion: TBD
 - Integration Testing Completion: TBD
 - System Testing Completion: TBD
 - UAT Completion: TBD

- Code freeze Period : TBD
- Deployment Date: TBD
- Release sign-off: TBD

5.2.1 Dependencies between tasks:

1. Core authentication and role management must be completed before role-specific workspace testing.
2. Editorial workflow must be completed before full publishing workflow testing.
3. Payment integration must be completed before subscription/payment UAT.
4. AI pre-screening must be completed before AI UAT.
5. System testing must pass before UAT.
6. User training must occur before pilot testing.
7. Pilot validation must occur before full production rollout.
8. Critical defects must be resolved before release sign-off.

6 Testing Strategy

- Types of testing to be performed: Unit Testing, Integration Testing, System Testing, User Acceptance Testing, Security Testing, Performance Testing, and Usability Testing.
- Testing environment: Development environment, QA environment, Staging environment (for UAT), Production environment
- Test data: Sample editorial submissions, Test user accounts, Test graphics/assets.
- Entry and exit criteria for each testing phase: Required feature is implemented, Build successfully deploys, Test accounts exist, Required APIs are configured.
- Test automation strategy: Automated checks for core workflows

6.1 Defect management process:

Severity Levels:

- **Critical:** System crash, Data corruption, or Core workflow unavailable.
- **High:** Major workflow blocked, Payment/subscription failure or AI service prevents essential workflow.
- **Medium:** Partial feature failure with workaround.
- **Low:** Cosmetic issues or Minor UI gaps.

7 Deployment Plan

Deployment Approach: Staged deployment with a pilot/dual-run period.

Novus will initially operate alongside the existing editorial workflow for at least one issue before full adoption.

7.1 Deployment Environment:

Cloud server with backup

7.2 Deployment Steps:

1. Final QA sign-off and data backup.
2. Obtain release approval.
3. Verify environment variables.
4. Deploy production version.
5. Run live tests.
6. Conduct user onboarding.
7. Grant pilot access.
8. Monitor system performance.
9. Collect feedback.
10. Resolve critical issues.

7.3 Rollback Plan:

Conditions: Major bugs, security breaches, and data corruption.

Procedure: Switch to backup snapshot, restore stable version.

Estimated Downtime: 2–4 hours or more depending on the issue.

Communication: Notify all stakeholders via email and MS Teams.

8 Communication Plan

- Communication channels: Email, Team messaging platform, Meetings
- Frequency of communication: Weekly project/release updates, Testing updates during QA/UAT, Immediate notification for Critical defects, and Daily/regular monitoring updates during pilot.
- Target audience (internal and external):

Internal:

- Development Team
- Project Adviser

External:

- Stakeholders
- Publisher, Editors, Writers, Graphics Designers, Reader/Subscriber users.

8.1 Stakeholder updates:

- Development status.
- Testing status.
- Known defects.
- Pilot results.
- Deployment readiness.
- Post-release issues.

9 Risk Management

Identification of Potential Risks:

Risk Assessment:

Potential Risk	Probability	Impact	Migration Strategy
System bugs/crashes	High	High	Automated testing, QA, staging
AI service failure	Medium	High	Queues, caching, fallback mechanisms
AI incorrect evaluation	Medium	High	Deterministic scoring
Payment failure	Medium	High	Test Payment integrations
Poor user adoption	Medium	High	Training, handbook, dual-run pilot
Performance issues	Medium	High	Load/performance testing
Deployment failure	Low	Critical	Staging + rollback plan
Data/security breach	Low	Critical	secure rules, audit logs
API rate limiting	Medium	High	Queueing and controlled API requests

9.1 Contingency Plans:

- If performance drops → optimize/scale infrastructure.
- If users struggle → conduct additional training.
- If production deployment fails → execute rollback.
- If payment service fails → temporarily disable affected transactions while retaining core CMS functionality.

10 Rollback Plan

Conditions for Rollback:

A rollback will be initiated if any of the following critical issues occur during or after deployment:

- Major system crashes occur.
- Authentication becomes unavailable.
- Editorial workflow becomes unusable.
- Critical data corruption occurs.

- Unauthorized access/security breach occurs.
- Payment processing creates serious transaction problems.
- Production deployment causes severe instability.
- Critical functionality cannot be restored within the release window.

Step-by-Step Rollback Procedure:

- Notify release team.
- Notify stakeholders.
- Pause user access.
- Restore last working version.
- Validate system stability.
- Notify all users.
- Identify the affected release.
- Verify article workflow.
- Document the incident.
- Identify corrective actions.

Responsibilities:

- **Release Manager:** Responsible for authorizing and overseeing the rollback process.
- **Development Team:** Executes rollback scripts, restores backups, and ensures system stability post-rollback.
- **Testing Team (QA Lead & Testers):** Conducts rapid validation checks after rollback to ensure functionality.
- **Communication Team:** Notifies stakeholders and users about the rollback, cause, impact, and recovery timeline.

Communication Plan for Rollback:

Affected users should be informed of:

- What happened.
- Which functionality is affected.
- Whether their data is safe.
- Whether subscriptions/payments were affected.
- Expected recovery status.
- Confirmation when the system is operational again.

11 Post-Release Activities

Monitoring and Support:

- Actively monitor Novus 24/7 during the first 2–4 weeks after launch to ensure stable performance and secure operations.
- Provide a dedicated support team to handle user inquiries, account issues, or workflow troubleshooting during business hours.

Performance Monitoring:

- Use system dashboards to track server uptime, integration status, and AI assistant performance.
- Track: Articles processed per month, User error rate, System usability, and Website performance

Bug Fixes and Hotfixes:

- Critical issues: immediate/hotfix release.
- High-severity issues: prioritized for the next maintenance release.
- Medium issues: scheduled maintenance.
- Low issues: backlog for future improvements.

User Feedback Collection:

- Gather user feedback through built-in surveys, direct staff input, and client follow-up calls.
- Monitor suggestions for improving workflows, approval processes, and client portal usability.

Release Review and Lessons Learned:

- Conduct a project retrospective meeting with the development, QA, and management teams to evaluate what worked and what didn't.
- Document lessons learned and recommended improvements for future Novus versions or new feature rollouts.
- Update internal guidelines based on feedback to optimize the next deployment cycle.